

gymbro

Install Guide

Get the workout tracker onto your own iPhone —
written for complete beginners. Every click is spelled out.

Repository:

<https://github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro>

Free to install with any Apple ID · no programming knowledge needed

1. What is gymbro, and what are we about to do?

gymbro is a personal workout and nutrition tracker: log workouts from ready-made plans, snap photos of meals to count calories with AI, speak your sets out loud, and watch your strength grow on charts. Everything stays on your phone — no account, no cloud.

Because gymbro is not on the App Store, you install it yourself using a Mac. Don't worry if you have never done anything like this: this guide assumes zero experience and walks through every single click. The one-time setup takes about an hour (mostly waiting for downloads). After that, keeping the app running takes two minutes a week.

2. What you need

- **A Mac** (any reasonably recent MacBook or iMac).
- **Your iPhone** and its **charging cable** (it must connect to the Mac).
- **An Apple ID** — the normal, free one you already use for the App Store.
- **About 15 GB of free disk space** on the Mac (the Apple developer tools are big).
- About **an hour**, most of it waiting for downloads.

Note: You do NOT need: a paid developer account, programming knowledge, or an Android phone (this guide is iPhone-only).

3. Sixty seconds of background (worth reading)

3.1 What is "Terminal"?

Terminal is an app that comes with every Mac. Instead of clicking buttons, you type a line of text and press **Enter** (Return), and the Mac carries out that instruction. That's the whole idea. You type a line — exactly as written in this guide — press Enter, and wait until new text stops appearing and you see the blinking cursor again. Then you type the next line.

To open it: press **■ (Command) + Spacebar**, type **terminal**, press Enter.

3.2 What does "cd" mean?

Terminal is always "standing inside" one folder, and commands act on that folder. `cd` (change directory) is how you walk into a folder. So `cd ~/Desktop/gymbro-main` means: "go into the gymbro-main folder on my Desktop". A trick that avoids typos: type `cd` (with a space), then drag the folder from Finder into the Terminal window — the path fills itself in — then press Enter.

3.3 What are Xcode, Node, and the rest?

- **Xcode** — Apple's free app for building iPhone apps. We use it to sign and install gymbro.
- **Node.js** — a free program that runs the app's build tools.
- **Homebrew & CocoaPods** — two small helper tools the build needs. Installed with one pasted line each.

4. One-time: install the tools (≈45 min, mostly waiting)

4.1 Install Xcode

- 1 Open the **App Store** app on the Mac.
- 2 Search for **Xcode**, click **Get**, then **Install**. It is a very large download (often 30–60 minutes) — start it and move on to step 4.2 while it downloads.
- 3 When it finishes, **open Xcode once**. Click **Agree** on the licence, let it "install components" if it asks, then you can close it.

4.2 Install Node.js

- 1 In a web browser, go to **nodejs.org**.
- 2 Click the big green **LTS** download button (the version number doesn't matter).
- 3 Open the downloaded `.pkg` file and click **Continue** → **Continue** → **Agree** → **Install**. Enter your Mac password when asked.

4.3 Install Homebrew, then CocoaPods

Open Terminal (⌘+Space → "terminal" → Enter). Copy-paste this whole line, press Enter, type your Mac password when asked (the password stays invisible while you type — that's normal), and follow any "press RETURN to continue" prompts:

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/install.sh)"
```

When Homebrew finishes it may print a box saying **"Next steps"** with two commands to run — copy-paste those two lines too (they connect Homebrew to your Terminal). Then install CocoaPods:

```
brew install cocoapods
```

Note: If a command replies "command not found: brew", you skipped the "Next steps" lines above — scroll up in Terminal, find them, and run them. Then close Terminal, reopen it, and try again.

5. Get the app's code (2 minutes)

The easiest way — no extra tools needed:

- 1 In a browser, go to **<https://github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro>**.
- 2 Click the green <> **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**.
- 3 Open your **Downloads** folder and double-click `gymbro-main.zip` — it unzips into a folder called **gymbro-main**.
- 4 Drag the **gymbro-main** folder onto your **Desktop**.

Note: That folder IS the app. Don't rename it or move things around inside it. (If a techie friend set you up with "git clone" instead, your folder is called **gymbro**, not `gymbro-main` — use that name in the commands below.)

6. Prepare the project (10 minutes, two commands)

In Terminal, go into the app folder:

```
cd ~/Desktop/gymbro-main
```

Now run these two commands, **one at a time**, waiting for each to finish. The first downloads the app's building blocks (2–5 minutes, prints a lot of text — warnings are normal). The second generates the iPhone project (a few more minutes):

```
npm install
npx expo prebuild -p ios
```

You're done when the cursor is blinking again with no error in red. A new **ios** folder now exists inside gymbro-main.

7. Connect your Apple ID (5 minutes, one time)

Apple requires every iPhone app to be "signed" by someone. You'll sign it with your own free Apple ID. In Terminal:

```
open ios/gymbro.xcworkspace
```

Xcode opens. Then:

- 1 Menu bar → **Xcode** → **Settings** (or Preferences) → **Accounts** tab.
- 2 Click the **+** in the bottom-left → **Apple ID** → sign in. Close Settings.
- 3 In the left sidebar, click the blue **gymbro** icon at the very top.
- 4 In the middle of the window, click the **Signing & Capabilities** tab.
- 5 Tick **Automatically manage signing**, and under **Team** choose your own name ("Personal Team").
- 6 If a red error says the bundle identifier is "**not available**": click in the **Bundle Identifier** box just above and change it to something personal, e.g. `com.yourfirstname.gymbro`. The error disappears.

8. Put gymbro on your iPhone

8.1 Prepare the phone (one time)

- 1 Plug the iPhone into the Mac with the cable and **unlock it**.
- 2 If the phone shows "**Trust This Computer?**" → tap **Trust**, enter your passcode.
- 3 On the phone: **Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → scroll to the very bottom → **Developer Mode** → turn it **On** → the phone restarts → unlock it and confirm.

Note: Can't find Developer Mode? It sometimes only appears AFTER the first install attempt. Do step 8.2 once, let it fail, then check Settings again — it will be there.

8.2 Install

- 1 In Xcode, look at the toolbar at the top. Next to the play button there is a device menu — click it and choose **your iPhone** (it's listed by name, above the simulators).
- 2 Press the **■ (play) button** in the top-left.

- 3 The first build takes 5–10 minutes. When it finishes, **gymbro appears on your iPhone**.
- 4 First open only: if the phone says "**Untrusted Developer**" → on the phone go to **Settings** → **General** → **VPN & Device Management** → tap your Apple ID → **Trust**. Open the app again.

That's it. The app greets you with a short welcome tour, and small green cards explain each feature the first time you reach it.

9. The 7-day rule (read this!)

Apps signed with a free Apple ID stop opening after **7 days**. This is an Apple restriction, not a bug. When gymbro suddenly won't open:

- 1 Plug the iPhone into the Mac and unlock it.
- 2 Open Xcode (your project reopens via **File** → **Recent**), make sure your iPhone is selected in the device menu, and press **■** again.

Two minutes, and the app runs for another 7 days. **Your workouts, meals, and settings are never lost** — reinstalling on top keeps all data.

10. Turn on the AI features (optional, free)

Photo food scanning and the nutrition coach use Google Gemini and need a free key:

- 1 On any device, go to aistudio.google.com/apikey, sign in with a Google account, click **Create API key**, and copy it.
- 2 In gymbro: **Home tab** → **Profile** → **AI features · Gemini key** → paste → **Save profile**.
- 3 The status line says "**Using your key**" — done. The key never leaves your phone.

11. Quick tour — what the app can do

- **Workouts tab** — start from a ready-made plan; your weights and reps from last time are pre-filled so you just try to beat them. Add/remove exercises mid-workout; a warm-up and cool-down checklist is generated for every session.
- **Guide me** — a coach mode that walks you through one set at a time with a rest timer.
- **Voice logging** — tap the mic and say "sixty by eight"; the set logs itself. Works offline, costs nothing.
- **Nutrition tab** — photograph your plate or scan a barcode; the AI counts calories and protein. Late-night meals ask whether they belong to yesterday or today.
- **Progress tab** — bodyweight, body fat %, and strength charts fill in automatically, with research-based insights (plateaus, volume spikes, neglected muscles).
- **Profile (Home tab)** — pick a training goal (it tunes plans and calorie targets), habit goals, and daily / long-term reminders with your own message.

Note: The app explains itself as you go: the first time you reach a feature, a small dismissible card describes it. It shows once and disappears after you use the feature or tap X.

12. When something goes wrong

12.1 Terminal says "command not found: npm" (or brew, or npx)

The tool from section 4 isn't installed or Terminal hasn't noticed it yet. Close Terminal completely (■Q), reopen it, try again. Still failing → redo the relevant part of section 4.

12.2 Terminal says "permission denied" or "no such file or directory"

Almost always a path problem. Use the drag-trick: type `cd` (with a space), drag the gymbro-main folder from Finder into the Terminal window, press Enter. Never run a folder path on its own without `cd` in front.

12.3 Xcode: "bundle identifier not available" / signing errors

Section 7, last step — change the Bundle Identifier to `com.yourname.gymbro` and re-pick your Team.

12.4 Xcode can't see my iPhone

- Unlock the phone and keep it unlocked; check the cable is properly in.
- Tap **Trust** if the phone asks (again — iOS updates re-ask).
- Check **Developer Mode** is On (section 8.1) — iOS updates sometimes switch it off.
- Still nothing → unplug, replug, wait 30 seconds.

12.5 The app icon suddenly does nothing

The 7-day signature expired — completely normal. Section 9. Your data is safe.

12.6 "Untrusted Developer" when opening the app

Phone → Settings → General → VPN & Device Management → your Apple ID → Trust.

12.7 AI says a key is missing

Section 10 — add your free Gemini key in Profile.

13. Where to get help

- Open an issue at github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro/issues — describe what you clicked and copy the exact error text.
- Google AI Studio (free Gemini keys) — aistudio.google.com
- Developers who want to modify the app: it's a standard Expo / React Native project — see the README at github.com/gagangeet2517-arch/gymbro.

This PDF is generated from `scripts/make_setup_pdf.py` — edit that file and re-run it to update the guide.